

I'd really like a utility that could scan my email inbox and return to me a list of all of the unique unsubscribe links

That actually sounds like a pretty useful utility.

The good news is that it's surprisingly feasible because most marketing emails contain a standard `List-Unsubscribe` header specifically designed for this purpose.

A rough architecture could be:

1. Connect to the user's mailbox (Gmail, Outlook, IMAP, etc.)
2. Fetch recent emails (or all emails)
3. For each message:
 - Check the `List-Unsubscribe` header
 - Fall back to parsing the HTML body for unsubscribe links
4. Normalize the URLs
 - Strip tracking parameters
 - Deduplicate by domain/path
5. Return a list like:

```
[
  {
    "sender": "news@example.com",
    "unsubscribe": "https://example.com/unsubscribe"
  },
  {
    "sender": "marketing@store.com",
    "unsubscribe": "https://store.com/preferences"
  }
]
```

You could then build some really interesting features on top:

Level 1: Export

Just give me a CSV:

Sender	Unsubscribe URL
Example Newsletter	...

Sender	Unsubscribe URL
Store Promo	...

Level 2: Bulk Cleanup

Show:

Found 437 mailing lists.

Tech newsletters (72)
Retail promotions (181)
Banking alerts
Receipts

Then unsubscribe from all selected.

Level 3: Inbox Diet

Rank subscriptions by:

- Number of emails received
- Last opened date
- Read vs unread ratio

Example:

Netflix Promo
84 emails received
0 opened
Last opened: Never

Remove?

Level 4: One-Time Scan

This is probably the most appealing version.

Users are understandably nervous about permanent email access.

Instead:

1. Sign in with Google.
2. Read mailbox metadata.
3. Build unsubscribe report.
4. Delete access token.
5. User downloads CSV.

No ongoing service required.

If you're thinking about making this as an Expo app, I'd actually position it less as "unsubscribe links finder" and more as:

"Find every mailing list you're subscribed to in under 60 seconds."

People understand that immediately.

The technical challenge isn't finding unsubscribe links—it's handling Gmail OAuth and processing potentially tens of thousands of emails efficiently. The actual extraction logic is relatively straightforward compared to the authentication and mailbox synchronization work.

One thing I particularly like: this solves a very specific pain point, can be completed in a single session, and has a clear "wow" moment when it says:

"You are subscribed to 612 mailing lists."

That's the kind of utility people share with friends.

Yeah that would be great. Should it be a cli package with a website on top like snaPDF and pixelator? Or just a web app? Or what?

I would not make this a CLI first.

For SnapDF and Pixelator, a CLI makes sense because developers are a natural audience. For an inbox unsubscribe scanner, the target audience is almost everyone, and almost nobody wants to install a package and authenticate Gmail from a terminal.

I'd consider three approaches:

Option 1: Pure Web App (my favorite)

User flow:

1. Visit site
2. Sign in with Google
3. Scan mailbox
4. See results
5. Sign out

Benefits:

- Lowest friction
- Easy to share
- No installation
- Natural OAuth flow

You could build the entire thing in:

- Next.js
- Supabase Auth
- Gmail API

and probably have an MVP in a weekend.

Option 2: Expo Mobile App

Benefits:

- Feels more private
- Nice for repeated use
- Can add ongoing inbox monitoring

Downsides:

- Users have to install something
- App Store review
- Harder initial adoption

I wouldn't start here.

Option 3: Local-First Desktop App

This one is interesting.

Think:

"The app never uploads your email."

Electron or Tauri app:

Scan Inbox

Process Locally

Show Results

Privacy-conscious users love this.

The downside is distribution.

Option 4: CLI + Website

I actually think this is the weakest option.

The overlap between:

- people who have inbox clutter
- people willing to install npm packages

is surprisingly small.

You'd be optimizing for developers instead of the larger audience.

What I'd build

I'd build:

unsubscribe.report

or

maildiet.app

or

inboxaudit.com

Simple landing page:

Connect Gmail

Scanning...

You are subscribed to 487 mailing lists

Show Results

Then:

Top Senders

Amazon - 341 emails

LinkedIn - 218 emails

Medium - 197 emails

with:

Open unsubscribe page

buttons.

The part that gets me excited isn't actually the unsubscribe links.

It's the analytics.

People *love* discovering things about themselves:

- "You've received 18,000 marketing emails this year."
- "80% came from 12 companies."
- "You haven't opened this newsletter in 3 years."

That turns a utility into something memorable and shareable.

If you were choosing among your side projects, I'd put this above yet another developer tool because it reaches a much broader audience and has a very obvious value proposition within seconds of use.